

M.E.N PREMIUM & SUBSCRIBER HELP · REVIEW, CONCEPT & BUSINESS CASE

Every M.E.N reader, to the right place, first time.

How one reChanneld front door can connect M.E.N Premium and Reachsubs print subscribers, clear up print offers across two sites, and support the first annual Premium renewals from November 2026.

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Concept on your site (separate PDF)

Dear George and the Reach Customer team,

The Manchester Evening News is where Reach's subscription story began: the first Reach brand behind a paywall, in November 2025, and the UK's largest local newsbrand with 12.6 million monthly readers. Its Premium product is clear and well made, with the Daily Briefing, Unmissable and expert Man Utd and Man City coverage.

We looked at the M.E.N as a subscriber would. The top bar offers “Buy a paper”, funeral notices, jobs and public notices, but no Help. Premium lives on the M.E.N site; print lives on Reachsubs, a separate site with a different look. The M.E.N page advertises print at **£31.85 a month, “save 50%”**; the first voucher checkout we reached on Reachsubs offered **£57.33 a month, “10% off”**.

And the first annual Premium members, who joined in November 2025, **renew next month**.

reChanneld is a channel-strategy platform from Helsinki. Its plug-and-play widget asks readers what they need and shows the best channel: self-service first, with honest opening hours and waiting times. It sits on top of the sites and systems you already have.

This pack contains:

1

Audit

The M.E.N and Reachsubs reviewed as a subscriber: 8 findings and a scorecard.

2

Concept

The real reChanneld widget on manchestereveningnews.co.uk, configured with Manchester Evening News's own topics. Nothing redesigned.

3

Business case

First renewals, the 2027 rules, a value model and an 8-week pilot on the M.E.N.

We'd welcome 20 minutes with you or the subscriptions team to walk through it.

Kind regards,

Touko Laakkonen

Service Channel Strategy, reChanneld · [e-mail] · [phone]

Reach's first paywall, and its template

What works at the M.E.N is copied across Reach. That makes it the natural place to design subscriber help for every brand.

12.6M

monthly audience: the UK's largest local newsbrand (+14.6%)

Nov 2025

M.E.N Premium launched: Reach's first paywall

£4.99

a month after a £1 first month, or £39.99 a year

£31.85

a month for print, as advertised on the M.E.N page

Timeline

- **Nov 2025** M.E.N Premium launches with an editor's letter from Sarah Lester; thousands sign up.
- **Early 2026** Liverpool Echo, Wales Online, Chronicle Live and others follow the M.E.N model.
- **Aug 2026** Reach passes 50,000 digital subscribers. Mirror North opens in Manchester.
- **Sep 2026** "Active engaged time" becomes Reach's north-star metric.
- **Nov 2026** First annual M.E.N Premium members renew at £39.99.
- **Jan 2027** UK subscription rules (DMCC Act) start: easy exit, cooling-off, reminders.

What this means for subscriber help

- **Two customer bases, two sites.** Premium on manchestereveningnews.co.uk, print on Reachsubs. Readers don't know which to contact.
- **Consistent offers matter.** Different print prices on two sites create questions, and distrust.
- **Renewals start now.** The first annual members renew in November 2026.
- **The template for Reach.** A help journey designed here can be copied to 25 brands.

The opportunity: **design subscriber help on the M.E.N first, and copy it to every Reach brand.**

manchestereveningnews.co.uk and Reachsubs, seen by a subscriber

Screenshots taken on 3 October 2026, following the print subscription journey from the M.E.N site to checkout.

1 · M.E.N subscribe page. Premium £1 then £4.99, or £39.99 a year. Print: £31.85 a month, “save 50%”.

2 · Reachsubs, a separate site. Vouchers from £13.23 a week, delivery £14.73, postal £22.80 (“save 10%”).

3 · Checkout. Vouchers: £57.33 a month, “10% off”; 3 months £171.99; 12 months £687.96.

£31.85 and “save 50%” on the M.E.N page; £57.33 and “10% off” at the first checkout we reached. The packages may differ, but the reader can't tell, and that's when they call, or leave.

8 findings

2/10

FINDING HELP

3/10

ONE JOURNEY
ACROSS SITES

3/10

PRINT OFFER CLARITY

6/10

PREMIUM CLARITY

8/10

PREMIUM VALUE
STORY

01 No Help in the M.E.N navigation CRITICAL

The top bar offers Buy a paper, funeral notices, jobs, advertising, newsletters, public notices and offers. Subscribers have no route.

→ A “Premium & subscriber help” button on every page, opening the widget.

02 Print and Premium live on two different sites CRITICAL

Premium is on the M.E.N site; print is on Reachsubs, with a different look and “Reach Publishing Services Ltd” in the footer.

→ One first question: “Which subscription do you have?”, then the right site.

03 Print prices don't match across the journey HIGH

£31.85 a month “save 50%” on the M.E.N page; £57.33 a month “10% off” at the first voucher checkout we reached.

→ A “Get the paper” topic that explains packages and prices in one place.

04 First annual Premium renewals arrive in November 2026 HIGH

Members who joined at launch renew at £39.99. Price questions and cancellations peak now.

→ A “Renewal & price” topic linked from reminder e-mails.

05 The FAQ is for non-subscribers MEDIUM

“Not a subscriber yet? ... take a look below.” Member questions aren't covered.

→ Member questions answered by the widget, with the FAQ kept for prospects.

06 Existing members get only a login button MEDIUM

“Already a Premium member? Login” is the only route on the subscribe page.

→ A members' topic list: log-in, Daily Briefing, billing, renewal, cancel.

07 Print readers need an honest phone route MEDIUM

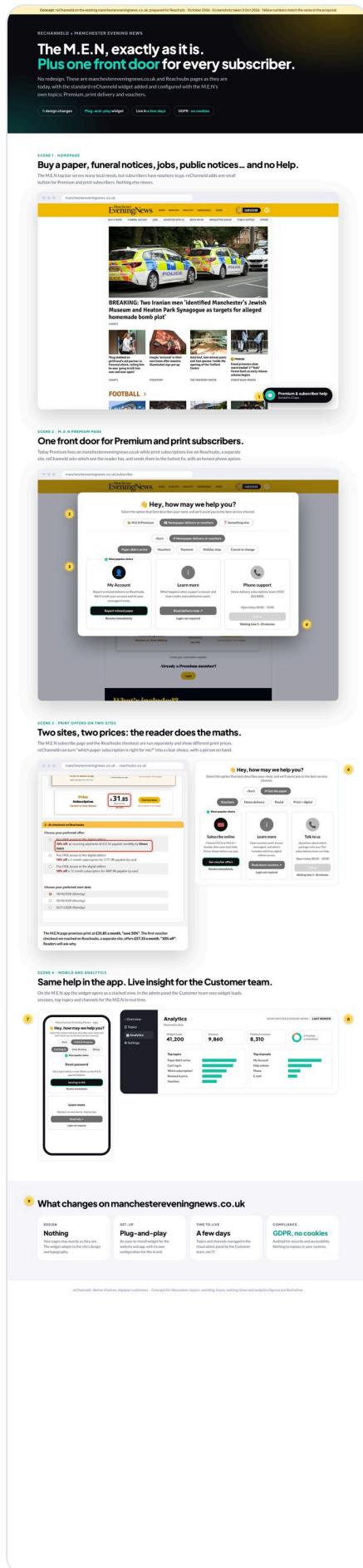
Reachsubs shows Home, FAQ and Contact links, but the M.E.N site gives no number or hours.

→ Phone support card with today's hours and typical waiting time.

08 No shared view of subscriber needs LOW

Premium and print contacts are handled in different places.

→ reChanneld analytics across both journeys.



Your pages, exactly as they are. Plus one front door.

Screenshots of manchestereveningnews.co.uk as it is today, with the standard reChanneld widget added and configured with Manchester Evening News's own topics. The full page is in **reChanneld-MEN-Concept.pdf**, and each yellow number matches a note below.

- 1 "Premium & subscriber help" button on manchestereveningnews.co.uk.** The site stays as it is. Finding 01.
- 2 First question: which subscription?** M.E.N Premium, newspaper delivery or vouchers, or something else. Finding 02.
- 3 Print topics.** Paper didn't arrive, vouchers, payment, holiday stop, cancel or change.
- 4 Honest phone option.** Today's hours and typical waiting time on the phone card. Finding 07.
- 5 Evidence across two sites.** M.E.N page vs Reachsubs checkout prices. Finding 03.
- 6 "Get the paper".** Vouchers, delivery, postal or print + digital, explained in one place, with a person on hand.
- 7 In the app.** Premium log-in help. Findings 05 and 06.
- 8 Analytics.** Widget loads, sessions, top topics and channels for the M.E.N. Finding 08.
- 9 What changes:** no design changes, plug-and-play, live in a few days, GDPR compliant with no cookies.

Why no redesign

The M.E.N site and Reachsubs both work. reChanneld doesn't replace either: it adds one front door on top and sends each reader to the right one, so it can go live in days.

The same pages, a very different experience

manchestereveningnews.co.uk/subscribe

Manchester Evening News NEWS MAN UTD MAN CITY UNMISSABLE MORE SUBSCRIBE

Hey, how may we help you?
Select the option that best describes your need, and we'll assist you to the best service channel.

M.E.N Premium Newspaper delivery or vouchers ? Something else

Back Newspaper delivery or vouchers

Paper didn't arrive Vouchers Payment Holiday stop Cancel or change

Most popular choice

My Account
Report a missed delivery on Reachsubs. We'll credit your account and let your newsagent know.
Report missed paper
Resolve immediately

Learn more
What happens when a paper is missed, and how credits and redeliveries work.
Read delivery help
Login not required

Phone support
Home delivery subscriptions team: 0333 202 8000.
Open today 08:00 – 18:00
Call us
Waiting time 5–10 minutes

Vouchers or Home Delivery billed monthly Save 50% Cancel anytime. Terms apply.

Cancel your subscription anytime.

Already a Premium member?

PREMIUM PAGE WITH THE WIDGET OPEN: NEWSPAPER DELIVERY → PAPER DIDN'T ARRIVE → REPORT MISSED PAPER

manchestereveningnews.co.uk → reachsubs.co.uk

ACCESS ON WEBSITE & App £139.99 billed annually Cancel anytime. Terms apply. Digital Subscription Save 20% Yearly

Print Subscription
Vouchers or Home Delivery **£31.85** billed monthly Save 50% Find Out More Cancel anytime. Terms apply.

2. At checkout on Reachsubs

Choose your preferred offer:

- ☒ Plus FREE access to the digital edition
10% off, as recurring payments of £57.33 payable monthly by **Direct Debit**.
- ☐ Plus FREE access to the digital edition
10% off a 3 month subscription for £171.99 payable by card.
- ☐ Plus FREE access to the digital edition
10% off a 12 month subscription for £687.96 payable by card.

Choose your preferred start date:

- ☒ 19/10/2026 (Monday)
- ☐ 26/10/2026 (Monday)
- ☐ 02/11/2026 (Monday)

Hey, how may we help you?
Select the option that best describes your need, and we'll assist you to the best service channel.

Back Get the paper

Vouchers Home delivery Postal Print + digital

Most popular choice

Subscribe online
Choose M.E.N or M.E.N + Sunday, then your start date. Prices shown before you pay.
See voucher offers
Resolve immediately

Learn more
How vouchers work at your newsagent, and what's included with free digital edition access.
Read about vouchers
Login not required

Talk to us
Questions about which package suits you? Our subscriptions team can help.
Open today 08:00 – 18:00
Call us
Waiting time 5–10 minutes

PRINT OFFERS ACROSS TWO SITES, AND A GET THE PAPER TOPIC THAT EXPLAINS THEM IN ONE PLACE

Proposed starting configuration for Manchester Evening News

First-level topics, sub-topics and the recommended channel for each. Built from public information; in a pilot, your own contact data decides the final structure and wording.

M.E.N Premium

Can't log in	Self-service
Daily Briefing & app	Guide
Billing	My Account
Renewal & price	My Account
Cancel	Equal choice

Newspaper delivery or vouchers

Paper didn't arrive	Reachsubs account
Vouchers	Reachsubs account
Payment or price	Article → phone
Holiday stop	Self-service
Cancel or change	Equal choice

Get the paper

Vouchers	Reachsubs
Home delivery	Reachsubs
Postal	Reachsubs
Print + digital	Talk to us

? Something else

A story or tip	Newsdesk form
Funeral & public notices	Notices pages
Advertising	Book an ad
Complaint	How to complain

Managed by the Customer team

Topics, texts, buttons, hours and the “Most popular choice” are edited in reChanneld's cloud admin panel and change instantly, without IT tickets or releases.

One template, every Reach brand

The M.E.N was Reach's first paywall. Its configuration can be copied to the Liverpool Echo, Wales Online, Chronicle Live and every Reach brand.

November 2026: the first M.E.N renewals

Annual members who joined at launch in November 2025 renew next month. Monthly members already moved from £1 to £4.99. How these moments are handled sets churn for the year ahead.

PLAN	OFFER	THEN	RENEWAL MOMENT
Premium monthly	£1 first month	£4.99 a month	After month one
Premium annual	£39.99 a year	£39.99 a year	From November 2026
Print (vouchers)	£31.85 a month on M.E.N	£57.33 a month at checkout	Monthly

UK subscription rules, from January 2027

- **Easy exit.** Consumers can end a contract with a clear statement, without unnecessary steps.
- **Cooling-off.** A 14-day cooling-off period at the start, and again after renewal.
- **Reminders.** Notices before renewals and before a free or discounted period ends.

Summary of the DMCC Act 2024 subscription regime from public guidance, not legal advice.

How the widget helps

- **Reminder e-mails link to a “Renewal & price” topic,** so questions land in self-service, not in the inbox.
- **Honest options side by side:** switch to annual, check what's included, and cancel online, all as equal choices.
- **Evidence:** analytics show how many readers chose each option, useful for the Customer team and for compliance.

Retention by service, not by friction: members who see what Premium gives them renew, and those who want to leave can do so in a minute.

A simple model to fill in together

We don't know Manchester Evening News's subscriber or contact volumes, so this is a worked example per 10,000 subscribers, with clearly stated assumptions. In the first call we'd replace them with real figures.

PER 10,000 SUBSCRIBERS	EXAMPLE
Contacts per subscriber per year	0.4
Subscriber contacts per year	4,000
Share moved to self-service by nudging	30%
Contacts avoided per year	1,200
Cost per assisted contact (reChanneld's ROI basis: €5)	≈ £4.30
Service saving per year	≈ £5,200
Subscribers kept at renewal (+2 percentage points)	200
Value of a kept subscriber per year (annual plan)	£39.99
Retained revenue per year	≈ £8,000

Where the value comes from

- **Retention first.** At Manchester Evening News's prices, keeping subscribers at renewal is worth more than service savings.
- **Fewer assisted contacts.** Log-in, billing and delivery questions move to self-service.
- **Faster help for those who call.** Shorter queues for complex cases.
- **Insight.** Real-time data on what readers need, for the Customer and product teams.

reChanneld's own benchmark

On reChanneld's published plans, ROI is reached by nudging around 5% of traffic, assuming €5 per contact. Clients typically see 79% of channel selections go to self-service, automation and leads.

Scale: the same configuration can be copied to every Reach subscription brand (25 by October), so the value multiplies across a base heading for 75,000 digital subscribers.

Prove it on Manchester Evening News, with your own data

Suggested scope: the M.E.N site and app plus the Reachsubs M.E.N pages, starting with the November 2026 renewals. The M.E.N then becomes the template for every Reach brand.

WEEKS 1-2

Map

Review three months of Manchester Evening News contact reasons, agree topics, channels and wording, and set the baseline. The widget itself can be live within days.

WEEKS 3-8

Guide

Widget live on manchestereveningnews.co.uk, the M.E.N app and the Reachsubs M.E.N pages. Wording and recommended channels adjusted weekly from the analytics.

WEEK 9

Decide

Review results together, then copy the configuration to the next Reach brands.

What we'll measure

KPI	HOW
Subscriber contacts per 1,000 subscribers	Your data, before vs during
Top topics and channels	reChanneld analytics
Finished sessions	reChanneld analytics
Missed-paper contacts by phone	Your data, before vs during
Renewal-topic choices	reChanneld analytics
Annual renewal rate	Your data

Who does what

reChanneld

- Configuration, topics and copy
- Analytics access and weekly check-ins
- Final report and rollout plan

Reach

- One Customer-team contact, about 2 hours a week
- Contact-reason data and current help links
- Adding the widget to the agreed pages

No redesign, no new chatbot and no change to subscription platforms. If it doesn't show results in 8 weeks, you stop.

“Welcome to M.E.N Premium”: a 40-second onboarding video

Most log-in and “where do I find...?” questions come in a member's first week. A short welcome video in the confirmation e-mail and app shows how to sign in, where the Daily Briefing lives, and where to find help.

0:00–0:06  “Welcome to M.E.N Premium” VISUAL The M.E.N bee on a phone. <i>“Welcome to M.E.N Premium. Thanks for backing Manchester journalism.”</i>	0:06–0:16  Sign in once on each device VISUAL Phone, laptop and tablet each show the sign-in. <i>“Sign in on each device, and fewer ads follow you.”</i>	0:16–0:24  Daily Briefing · Unmissable VISUAL Morning briefing in the app. <i>“Your Daily Briefing, Unmissable and expert United and City insight.”</i>
0:24–0:32  “Hey, how may we help you?” VISUAL The reChanneld widget: Can't log in → Send log-in link. <i>“Any question? The help button sorts it in seconds.”</i>	0:32–0:36  Your plan, your choice VISUAL Renewal & price topic. <i>“Check your renewal or change your plan, any time.”</i>	0:36–0:40 M.E.N Premium Help: one tap away VISUAL End card in M.E.N yellow. <i>“Enjoy your M.E.N.”</i>

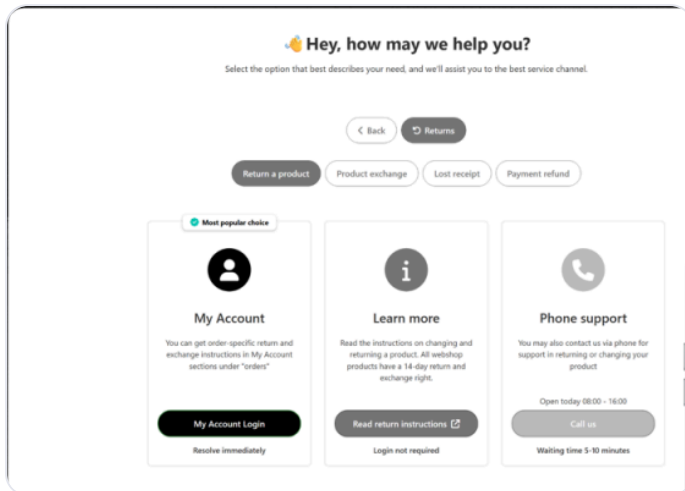
Formats

9:16 for the app and social, 16:9 for web, plus a GIF and a 15-second cut for e-mails. Captioned throughout.

Where it lives

The Premium confirmation e-mail, the M.E.N app's first launch, and the help page. A 15-second cut can run with the November renewal reminders.

Better choices. Happier customers. Lower costs.



The reChanneld widget as it works today: topic, sub-topic, channel cards and the “Most popular choice”.

reChanneld is a channel strategy platform from Helsinki, Finland. A plug-and-play widget uses behavioural economics and digital nudges to guide customers to the best service channel. Customer service teams manage it themselves in a cloud admin panel, and it works on top of their existing website and channels.

4M+

annual sessions

79%

channel selections to self-service, automation and leads

87%

of end users found reChanneld easy and clear

Days

to define and implement a channel strategy

“Within just a few days we were able to nail our service channel strategy with reChanneld. Nudges work excellently, and we offer a far more intuitive experience to our customers than before!”

Teresa Alander, Head of Operations, Lippu.fi (part of CTS Eventim)

Used by

S-Bank, Nets, Lippu.fi, PAM, Sportson, Laurea, Varha and Satakunta wellbeing services county. They cover banking, payments, ticketing, retail, education and the public sector.

Enterprise-ready

Audited for security and accessibility, GDPR compliant, no cookies. White-labelled per brand. Enterprise plan with unlimited admin users and integrations.

Shall we take 20 minutes?

We'd love to hear how Manchester Evening News subscriber help works today, and where it hurts most.

Touko Laakkonen
reChanneld • [e-mail] • [phone]